Four-part series | delivery protected to W11

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Decision objective

Give Cormac Duarte a schedule that exposes what is waiting, what has float, and which slip consumes scarce suite access first.

Contractual finish

END OF WEEK 11

Friday 2026-03-20

Plan signal

E3 is the delivery-constraining lane.

Six working days remain after QC.

Read this deck as a keyed operating model:

the shared grade suite is a scarce, split resource; captions and distributor QC are downstream gates, not instant milestones.

Calendar, suite windows, and the selected reading

One holiday is excluded from working-day counts

Working calendar

Weeks 1–11: Mon 2026-01-05 → Fri 2026-03-20

Public holiday: Wed 2026-02-04 (week 5) — no suite booking, no working-day count.

Selected interpretation

Readiness/resource-block reading: consume early access with ready E1/E4, place E2 in week 5, and reserve weeks 7–8 for the later E3 stems.

Why this wins recovery room

A strict episode sequence would strand the early blocks while E3 waits. This choice keeps E3's only late grade window visible and leaves six working days after QC.

Suite is shared with two other jobs; blocks are availability windows, not a continuous reservation.

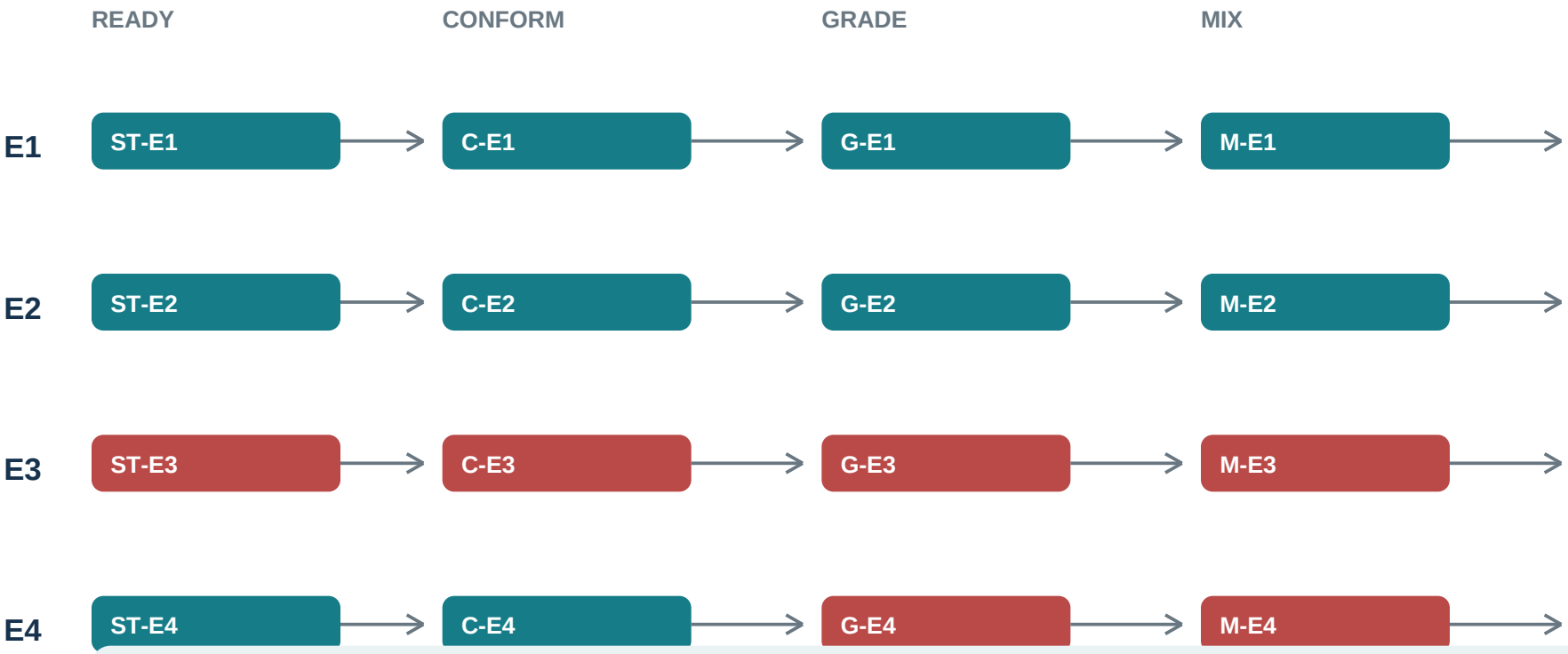
Eleven-week operating view

Bars are calendar spans; durations are working days in the workbook.

Critical chain highlighted in coral

Episode gates and shared downstream handoffs

Arrows show predecessor → successor



Shared gate logic

CAP-ALL waits for all four mixes (M-E1, M-E2, M-E3, M-E4), then QC-ALL waits for captions. DEL-ALL is the contractual milestone after QC.

Shared suite allocation

Three availability blocks; four deliberate grade assignments

W1–2	2026-01-05 to 2026-01-16 Ready episodes consume early access	**G-E4 + G-E1**
W5	2026-02-02, 03, 05 2026-02-04 holiday closed	**G-E2**
W7–8	2026-02-16 to 2026-02-27 Reserved for later E3 stems	**G-E3**

Control point: a slip cannot create new suite days. Re-plan within the displayed windows or escalate the downstream package.

Critical chain, float, and recovery room

Float convention: working days from task end to 2026-03-20, less one

Critical chain

ST-E3 → C-E3 → G-E3 → M-E3 → CAP-ALL → QC-ALL → DEL-ALL

E1 conform (C-E1)	**5 wd**	Recovery until captions gate; a 6th day reaches package readiness.
E2 grade (G-E2)	**7 wd**	Can move within W5/W7 only if suite capacity is explicitly reallocated.
E3 conform (C-E3)	**0 wd**	Stem arrival and late suite window make this chain delivery-constraining.
QC-ALL	**14 wd**	QC completion on 2026-03-05 leaves six working days to contractual delivery.

Meaningful float is not empty time: it is the amount that can be consumed before a named successor or deadline moves.

Slip-response view

Inspect the next constrained gate before asking for a new commitmen

If E3 stems slip

First threatened: C-E3 → G-E3.

Protect W7; re-sequence conform immediately. A 2-day slip consumes the late suite margin and moves captions/QC.

If E1 conform slips

Use its 5 wd float.

Monitor M-E1 and the all-episode captions gate; escalate on day 6, not day 1.

If W5 grade is lost

Do not assume a continuous reservation.

Check whether W7 can absorb E2 without displacing E3; otherwise protect E3 and escalate the E2 package.

Before captions / QC

Confirm every mix is clear.

CAP-ALL is five working days; QC starts only after captions and all upstream grade/mix work are complete.

Decision checks | answer key and rationale

Use the schedule and assumptions shown in this package

Q1 **Selected interpretation?** **Readiness/resource-block reading.**

It spends early access on ready E1/E4 and protects W7 for later E3 stems.

Q2 **First gate threatened by a 2-day E3-stem slip?** **C-E3, then G-E3.**

The only planned late suite window is W7; downstream mix, captions and QC move with it.

Q3 **How many constrained grade assignments?** **4 assignments across 3 blocks.**

G-E4 + G-E1 in W1–2, G-E2 in W5, G-E3 in W7; W5 holiday is excluded.

Q4 **Which task has recoverable float?** **C-E1: 5 working days.**

Its successor chain reaches the shared captions gate with five working days of room.

Q5 **What must clear before QC?** **All mixes and the 5-day captions window.**

QC-ALL is distinct and starts 2026-03-03, after CAP-ALL ends 2026-03-02.

Decision owner: Cormac Duarte | Escalate when a named float is consumed or a fixed suite block is at risk.